

SB-2026-03 Slide-out seal inspection and replacement

Subject

Rear bedroom slide-out seal on 2024 Aria 28 travel trailers and living room slide-out seal on 2024 Aria 24 travel trailers: inspection and replacement of the outer bulb seal. Issued 2026-03-12. Supersedes none.

Affected units

This bulletin applies to Aria 24 (VIN prefix 1THRA24) and Aria 28 (VIN prefix 1THRA28) units with a certification label build date between 02/2024 and 08/2024 inclusive. Units built before February 2024 or after August 2024 received bulb seal from a different lot and are not affected. The build date is printed on the federal certification label inside the entry door as MM/YYYY.

On the Aria 28 the affected seal is the rear bedroom slide outer bulb seal. On the Aria 24 the affected seal is the living room slide outer bulb seal. The Aria 28 living room slide uses a different seal profile and is not part of this bulletin.

Condition

Owners report water on the bedroom floor along the inboard edge of the rear slide after rain with the slide retracted, and in some cases with the slide extended. Inspection shows the outer bulb seal from the affected lot loses its round profile after 12 to 18 months of compression cycles and stays flattened when the room is extended. The flattened seal no longer bridges the 3/8 inch gap between the slide fascia and the sidewall flange, allowing water to run behind the fascia and into the floor cavity. Unrepaired, the condition causes delamination of the floor decking within one season.

Inspection procedure

1. Park the trailer on level ground and lower the stabilizer jacks.
2. Extend the affected slide fully and hold the switch until the motor clicks off.
3. From outside, inspect the outer bulb seal along the top and both sides of the room opening. A healthy seal is round in section and stands 3/4 inch off the sidewall flange.
4. Press the seal with a thumb at 12 inch intervals. A seal that stays compressed for more than 2 seconds after release has failed.
5. Check the top corners for splits. Any split longer than 1/2 inch is a failure.
6. Retract the slide and check the seal-to-fascia contact line. A gap visible anywhere along the top edge is a failure.
7. Inside, pull back the carpet along the inboard edge of the slide and probe the floor decking. Soft decking must be reported to THOR before repair; floor repair requires separate authorization.
8. If the seal passes all checks, record the inspection under the claim code below and no further action is needed until the next 6 month service.

Repair procedure

Parts required: one seal kit SEAL-SO-RR per slide. The kit contains the outer bulb seal cut to length for the Aria 28 rear slide (Aria 24 kits are identical in profile and are trimmed to fit), 8 oz of adhesive, twelve stainless retaining screws, and a corner splice.

1. Extend the slide fully and turn off the 12V disconnect.

2. Remove the twelve retaining screws along the seal flange with a #2 square drive and pull the old seal from the flange. Note the position of the corner splice.
3. Scrape residual adhesive from the flange and clean with isopropyl alcohol. Allow to dry 10 minutes.
4. Apply a 1/4 inch bead of the kit adhesive to the flange channel.
5. Starting at the top center, press the new seal into the channel and work toward each corner. Install the corner splice at the top corners with the bulb continuous.
6. Install the twelve retaining screws and torque to 15 in-lb. Overtightening crushes the flange and deforms the seal.
7. Allow the adhesive to cure for 4 hours at or above 60 degrees F before retracting the slide. Below 60 degrees F, allow 8 hours. Do not use heat guns to shorten cure.
8. Retract and extend the slide twice and confirm the seal compresses evenly along the full perimeter.
9. Water test with a garden hose for 5 minutes along the top edge with the slide retracted. Check inside for moisture.
10. Treat the new seal with dry silicone spray and record the work.

Parts

SKU	Description	Quantity per slide
SEAL-SO-RR	Slide-out outer bulb seal kit with adhesive, screws, and corner splice	1

Dealer net price is 148 dollars per kit. Order through the dealer portal parts module. Kits ship from the Indiana parts center within 3 business days.

Labor allowance

Operation	Hours
Inspection only, seal passes	0.3
Seal replacement including inspection and water test	1.8
Additional slide on same unit (Aria 28 both slides inspected)	0.2

Floor decking repair is not included in this allowance and requires separate pre-authorization with photographs.

Warranty claim coding

Submit claims through the dealer portal using failure code SO-SEAL-24 and bulletin reference SB-2026-03. Inspection-only claims use operation code SB2603-INSP; replacement claims use SB2603-REPL. This bulletin extends coverage on the affected seal to 48 months from delivery for the units listed, regardless of the standard 12 month wear item limit. Claims must be submitted within 30 days of repair. Attach a photograph of the certification label and of the removed seal to each replacement claim.